

WHY AM I THE WAY I AM?

Imagine if everyone was the same—what a boring world it would be. In any given conversation, we'd be able to predict responses, thoughts, and opinions. Thankfully, we all have very different personalities and respond to situations and other people in our own individual way. From hitting it off with one person to clashing with another, we discover that no two personalities match. It is these differences that make life's interactions so rich, varied, and interesting.



ASTROLOGY

In ancient times, the most popular explanation for personality came from astrology and the idea that the time, day, and date of your birth determined your character. Today, many people still follow the readings given for their own zodiac sign and believe that it applies to them specifically. This simplified version can never be very personal, as millions of people share the same sign, but they can't all have the same personality.

NATURE-NURTURE

When asked whether nature (genes) or nurture (experiences) contributed more to personality, Canadian psychologist Donald Hebb (1904-1985) replied, "Which contributes more to the area of a rectangle, its length or its width?" He was making the point that you cannot choose between them. Psychologists agree, accepting that a combination of the two is what makes up an individual's personality.

IDENTICAL TWINS

Genes have a big influence on individual personality, and this has been confirmed in studies of identical twins. As they share genes, any differences between them must come from their experiences (nurture). Results revealed that as well as sharing the main aspects of personality, identical twins share similar intelligence, eyesight, medical problems, and weight. However, genes have less influence on twins' senses of humor.